

Examples of such stores are many but the one that we are all familiar with is Amazon globally and Flipkart, Infibeam, and Indiaplaza within India. Business models such as these are popular for the same reason that

malls are popular – you only need to go to one place to find a multitude of products from various brands. But why online? Well, because these online megamalls pass on cost savings in the form of discounted products and customers can buy these anytime, yes even during office hours.

The key to the success of such business models is scale. “Through online megamalls, people have the privilege of being able to compare a wide variety of brands, styles and prices easily through the comfort of their home. Such sites have become very popular not only in metros but also in the smaller cities as people in India today have the aspiration and purchasing power to buy but often not the accessibility to a particular brand”, says Praveen Sinha, Founder of Jabong.com which is another entrant within the megamall category in India.

To ensure that their business model continues to remain relevant, the online mall has evolved greatly since its birth. Some of the latest features include:

- ▶ Ability to read product reviews before buying a product. Much like taking your friend shopping with you, only better.
- ▶ Super fast delivery times so the thrill and satisfaction of buying something is retained
- ▶ Open box policies so that the customer can touch & feel the product before accepting delivery
- ▶ Cash on delivery, so you don't need to pay for it until your new gizmo is safely in your hands.



Marketplace

In terms of size, the marketplace concept is as popular as the megamalls and has enabled the creation of a virtual ‘main-street’ of the world. At the core of the marketplace concept is the community. Here, the site enables multiple smaller stores to co-exist and operate within a common eco-